



ON THE HIGHWAY TO PROSPERITY

Nitin Gadkari,
Minister of Road Transport and Highways

- » The central government is aiming to develop India's road infrastructure on par with that of the US by the end of 2024
- » There are robust future plans for the Bharatmala project and Green Express highways
- » The government is trying to create awareness about road safety along with improving road engineering
- » NHAI's infra investment bonds—NHAi InVITs—are supporting the government's national monetisation pipeline
- » Politics prevents exempting VIPs from paying tolls



READING THE BUDGET'S FINE PRINT

(From left) **Sourav Majumdar**, Editor, *Business Today*, with

T.C.A. Anant,
Former Chief Statistician of India;
Former Member, UPSC

Soumya Kanti Ghosh,
Group Chief Economic Advisor, SBI

Abheek Barua,
Chief Economist, HDFC Bank

Ramesh Chand,
Member, NITI Aayog

» The government has done well by giving precedence to growth over populism at a time when general elections are due in 2024

» Ruling parties are finally being forced to seek votes based on economic performance, rather than merely announcing doles ahead of elections

DEBATING THE BUDGET

(From left)
Rahul Kanwal, with

Sudhanshu Trivedi, BJP MP, Rajya Sabha, and National Spokesperson, BJP

Supriya Shrinete, Chairperson, Social Media & Digital Platforms and National Spokesperson, Congress

Ashwani Mahajan, National Co-convenor, Swadeshi Jagran Manch



» Although PM Narendra Modi has termed the MGNREGA scheme as a monumental failure of the UPA government, his government has continued to increase the outlay for the scheme even after nine years in office, said Supriya Shrinete

» Unlike the UPA government, the

BJP-led government has presented a Budget that will strengthen the fundamentals of the economy, said Sudhanshu Trivedi

» In the backdrop of the Adani-Hindenburg issue, Shrinete demanded a discussion in Parliament as public sector institutions like

SBI and LIC have exposure to the Ahmedabad-based group

» Agreeing with her, Ashwani Mahajan said that the issue should be discussed in Parliament